

Nan Jiang

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Dear Sir/Madam,

I am writing this letter to apply for the position – “Assistant Professor of Business, Economics”. After reading the job description and qualification of this position in detail, I believe I will be a good fit for this role.

I just got my Ph.D. in Economics at Fordham University in May 2023. I have been teaching principles of microeconomics as an instructor since September 2021 and have taught a total of six courses. I also served as a teaching assistant of two Ph.D. level core courses - Macroeconomic Theory and Mathematic Methods for Economics. In my teaching, I strove to create an academic environment that was supportive of all students, including those from underrepresented groups. I used a range of pedagogies that address different learning styles, designed courses that were tailored to meet the needs of educationally disadvantaged students, and mentored underrepresented students to build a more inclusive pipeline into academia. I also selected course content that reflected diverse viewpoints, including work from scholars from underrepresented groups. My goal is to create an environment where every student feels valued and supported, and where they can develop the skills and knowledge necessary to succeed in their academic pursuits.

My current research focuses on the application of stochastic dominance, machine learning methods, and information fusion in stock-ranking and risk portfolio management. The ranking algorithm incorporates an ensemble learning method that can combine results from various machine learning models in both the score space and rank space. To be more specific, data and information fusion has been applied in my research so as to level up the prediction performance in a comprehensive manner. The simulated portfolio based on the ranking lists significantly outperforms the iShares S&P 500 in both cumulative returns and Sharpe ratio. I am also currently preparing for submitting it to the “Journal of Financial Stability”. Dr. Frank Hsu, the Clavius distinguished professor in the department of computer and information sciences at Fordham University, who is also one of my dissertation committee members, has spent years developing and improving data and information fusion methods and applying them to various domains. Meanwhile, I am currently also working on the application of information fusion of models in the field of therapeutic science and have derived some outstanding results that rank combinations of models with different weighting schemes can deliver more accurate ranking predictions.

Before I entered the Economics Ph.D. program at Fordham University, I used to work at OBEX Securities with a role on prime brokerage management and development and execution of quantitative strategies through intensive research on stock ranking listwise predictions with machine learning and information fusion.

I have also worked at the bond financing department of the second largest securities company in China, Haitong Securities, for more than three and a half years. I was mainly responsible for the due diligence, underwriting, issuing and distribution of all kinds of fixed income products, including enterprise bond, corporate bond, private placement bond, convertible bond, perpetual bond, mid-

term note, asset backed security, etc. Working at Haitong Securities has made me intimately familiar with China's financial market and very detail oriented. As a senior associate, I visited hundreds of state-owned enterprises (SOEs) and small and medium enterprises (SMEs) in towns and cities across eastern and southern China and those experiences made me grasp the essence of maintaining relationship with current clients and developing new clients. I believe my previous background and experience could make me a good fit for this position.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Best,
Nan Jiang